

Interviewer: So, we're only going to be recording for transcription and note-taking.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Ummm. So, we can get to it po. Thank you again. So, how old are you po, [Participant's Name]?

Speaker: Me? Guess. I'm [50-55], turning [56-60] this year.

Interviewer: Oh, wow. 'Di po halata.

Speaker: Oh, Thank you.

Speaker: 'Di ano 'yan, phinotoshop ko sa Zoom. Diba pwede may touch-up appearance?

Interviewer: Ah, yes po.

Speaker: They say I'm younger looking than my age. So, I guess I thank God for that.

Interviewer: Winning the genetic lottery po.

Speaker: Correct! Yah. Hmmm.

Interviewer: You mentioned po before we began recording that you've been together with your partner. With your husband for [26-30] years, no?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Do you have any children?

Speaker: Yes. We have [1-5], a daughter. Yeah. And she's turning [20-25] this year.

Interviewer: Turning [20-25]. So, mga [educational attainment] po siya, 'no?

Speaker: Yes. So, she's in her [first-fourth] year [degree] in the [Country].

Interviewer: Does she live in the household with you po?

Speaker: Yes. She goes where we go. Unica hija eh. The only one. Because we had her [6-10] years into the marriage, going [6-10]. So, we thought we won't have kids anymore. But God blessed us with a kid just at the right time. Yeah.

Interviewer: Who else lives in the household po?

Speaker: Here. Well, just the [1-5] of us and maids. We have house helps. [1-5] of them. And then this, we have an adjacent, well, we have an office, but it has a separate entrance. So, but it's attached to the house. So, there. They're not part of the household. We don't see them. So, yeah.

Interviewer: So, more of [1-5] people in your family?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Ummm. How would you like us to address your partner po? Si [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: Yah. [Partner's Name]. Yah.

Interviewer: Sige po. [Partner's Name].

Interviewer: Can you tell me about your love story with [Partner's Name]?

[Portion Redacted]

Interviewer: Oh, I wanted to ask [Participant's Name], how would you compare the quality? Sorry po?

Speaker: Just call me [Participant's Name].

Interviewer: Sige po, [Participant's Name]. How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends' relationships?

Speaker: My, my former boyfriend or my, uh, friends?

Interviewer: Friends. Like your peers.

Speaker: My peers. Okay. Um, you know, you know, we're very exclusive 'no, [Name]. In fact, the friends that I would, um, I have friends in the office. I have friends, uh, in church, but most, most of my closest friends are those that are in church. Well, I guess, siguro I didn't like what I was before when I knew Christ. And, um, I didn't really keep in touch with my friends of before, kasi parang that was the past that I wanted to, I turned a new leaf and I don't want to go back to that. In fact, ano ako nga eh, uh,, but, uh, [1-5] years ago, I attended, um, parang um, what you call this reunion. And it's so nice to touch base with my old friends. Pero parang alam mo 'yon I guess I was a wild, uh, high schooler at that time. And then they saw change. Parang, "uy naging manang ka na." Parang gano'n 'diba? Kasi I was really, I guess, alam mo 'yon? The teenager na ano na, nagbubulakbol, things like that, but I don't sleep around naman. It's, it's, um, you know, it really enjoyed my high school life. Yeah. And I guess I knew it was wrong now. That's why I said that's the old me and I don't enjoy that anymore. And so to tell you about it, [Partner's Name] is my friend. [Partner's Name] is, in fact, um, he knows everything. Um, even early on in marriage, uh, we all, we said, uh, we made a pact that we shouldn't keep things, things from each other. So, you know, everything is open. Although at the start, medyo syempre ako mahilig akong bumili. Mahilig akong bumili ng alahas, ng kung ano-ano, 'diba? And bigla na lang may makikita siyang ano bagong purchase, 'diba? 'Yon. So, he would tell me right away na this is part of what we have agreed on. 'Yon. If you want us to, you know, not argue about it. And gano'n din naman siya. So I would say, yes, he would be my best friend. Yeah.

Interviewer: You did meet po as friends and then like nagka-developan po kayo.

Speaker: Yes. Yes. I mean, he's my favorite person in the whole world, I would say. And he, I am, I look forward to coming home. Kahit na I mean, he's a night, he's a day person. And I'm a night person. Even if he doesn't, he was just, just sleeps beside me and I watch TV. I'm, I'm happy. 'Yon. I don't, I don't go out with friends. I mean, I di ko hinahanap 'yon because for me, that's him. It's him and my, my daughter. Yeah, Boring, no, but that's how it is.

Interviewer: Would you say that, um, your relationship po is high quality?

Speaker: Well, high quality is a benchmark that is set by, I guess, uh, you have to have, uh, a basis, right? If you are, if you are saying high quality from the standpoint of what the Bible says, I would say we still are a work in progress. But if you compare it with, uh, with the common, the norm now, sadly, um, kasi I see a lot of, uh, we, we also [religious leader] to couples by the way in church. And, uh, I've seen how,

how marriages disintegrate just like that. Right. So I would say we are blessed. We are, um, God is gracious to our marriage that we have lasted this long. Yeah. And, um, we are able to, uh, um, work out their marriage and be able to minister to other couples do the same. Yeah. But all, all because of his grace, not, not through our own efforts.

Interviewer: That's a really great mission po. And we are doing the interview after all to understand, uh, what relationship quality means for you because it's very subjective as you mentioned po.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Um, how about, uh, you mentioned that a relationship being high quality can be in terms of the Bible and in terms of norms. Um, what would make a relationship low quality po kaya?

Speaker: Well, foremost, no, um, in a relationship, it's always a three person. Uh, it's, it's like, uh, it's a triangle relationship. It's never, it's never dual because, um, you have to have an arbiter or you have to have a foundation, 'diba? Like a rope, if you would picture a rope and it's actually a biblical verse now, uh, a rope of three strands is not easily broken. And in a marriage, if you have God in the center who holds you, it becomes stronger. Kasi if it's just the two of you, you're, we're both ano eh, we're both flawed. And, uh, if we look at ourselves, it's really a flawed person there. But if you look in, you look to Christ, you know, um, then you can see from His point of view, how to love the unlovely kasi we can really be a unlovely persons to each other 'no. And, um, in the marriage, you really see the worst in, in every day. And believe me, [Interviewer's Name], there were times ako madalas ako "hiwalayan na tayo." So, and he hates that. He hates it when I say that na you easily say those words. Of course, I don't mean it, but out of anger and frustration, I would say that, you know, "I better pack up your things. I'll pack up my things." Ganyan. So, but, um, I would say, I know, I would, we could have not gone through all those worst times of our lives if it weren't for, for God talaga, for Jesus Christ kasi He, at the very onset, He was already the foundation of this marriage. And to answer your question, if, if a relationship doesn't start with Jesus in it, I think it would be doomed to destruction. And my prayer for every couple that they would know Christ first personally in their lives and that they will bring Christ into the marriage.

Interviewer: Um [Participant's Name], can you tell me more about how one knows that one is in a Christ-centered relationship?

Speaker: Okay. Number one is, you know, in our lives 'diba, we have a will, 'diba? Lahat tayo may will, right? And in that, in that person, there's, when you say you the will, the person or the person who, who is followed, whose will is followed, is the Lord of that. So, before I knew Christ, it was just me, whatever I want, whatever I decide, whatever, uh, whatever it is that suits me. But when I, when I came to know Christ, it's now going to be, oh, what does Christ think? Is this what Christ would do? Is this according to how the Lord is, is leading, leading me into. So, kami ni [Partner's Name], we had that first before we knew each other. Um, and that's why at the onset pa lang, even before I even considered going into a relationship with him, pinagpray na kasi there was, there is this person, and I believe that he is the person that Christ prepared for me. The best person, no? So, and, and vice versa. So, uh, your question is, how do you know it's Christ-centered? It begins with the individual person. Yeah, because, uh, I'm not saying that if in a relationship, the yung isa is not in Christ, it's not going to work. It does because Christ is sovereign eh, no matter what the circumstances. But it would be harder. Kasi, ano yan eh, you don't jive. If you, if you picture a triangle, right? And if at the peak of the triangle is Christ, and you're, and you

are in unison going to that direction. You get together, 'diba? So, if this is me, and this is [Partner's Name], and this is Christ on top. As we grow, as we draw near to Christ, we draw near to each other. So that's the picture of having a Christ-centered relationship. I hope I answered you.

Interviewer: I'm learning a lot po, actually. Um, apart from, um, being shared, uh, sharing religion po and, um, centering Christ in your life as an arbiter, are there any other qualities po of a high quality, uh, of a, yes, high quality relationship?

Speaker: Okay. What we thought, what we, what I found to be very, very useful is, um, honesty. Kasi a marriage or any kind of relationship for that matter, that is not, that is founded in lies, is already on the wrong, ano eh, on the wrong foot, right? Kasi if you, even with little things, if you hide things from your husband, your spouse, then it can snowball eh. So very, that's paramount honesty and openness and communication. So, um, you don't hide anything. Everything is an open book. That's why it's good that if your spouse is your best friend, if you can open up things with him, no? Um, so we make it a point every day before we go to bed. We always read the Bible, we pray for each other and we ask each other, how did your day go? And then, um, we talk about it, no? And, um, and it's always a conscious effort, not to lie, not to, not to candy-coat, no? Even if it's going to be, you know, early on in my our marriage, syempre yung naliligawan ka 'diba. I mean, ligawin daw ako. Pero ano kasi, when we were younger, kasi because I'm in this industry now, clients would really try to ano flirt with you and at that point, of course, he is jealous about it and it has become a strain in our relationship early on. And for me, kasi I'm in [department], parang sa'kin I didn't think highly of it. I mean, I just took lightly of it. Of course, I don't like the idea of giving him anything and going out on a date with him or something, but sa kanya important yung putting a hedge at the onset pa lang, because even if I'm not party to it, the other person can disconstrue it as, you know, an invitation. So sa kanya very important 'yun. And I agree with him to put a hedge in our marriage, because talaga ngayon, you know what? Even if you're married, you know, and I've seen it first, kahit mas parang challenge pa nga 'yun eh. If they try to see if you can open up and accept their advances, may mga gano'n, 'no? And it's really sad. Really sad. It really shows what a fallen world we are in. Yeah.

Interviewer: You mentioned po um some challenges like being flirted with, and um mahilig bumili ng alahas po kayo sometimes. Well, actually, I'm not sure if that's a challenge.

Speaker: Ngayon bag—

Interviewer: Mga luho po. What would you say are the other challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: Um, well, when we were newly married ano, my mom, well until now naman, kasi my mom can be really overbearing. So, syempre torn ako because I'm the only child left here with my mom, my dad passed on already, my siblings are all abroad. So, I'm very, I'm very, you know, I guess that's [Nationality] culture, especially my mom is so, um, I mean, all of her in-laws are, you really have to step up. Parang ganyan. She's really a hard mother in law to deal with, I would say. So sometimes I'm torn, and there were many occasions that we would fight over her in our trips abroad when we bring my mom. Mga ganyan. Nag-aaway kami. So, I would say that. Then, of course, there's child rearing. So syempre, you have your ways 'diba? You have, um, especially 'pag during at least younger years, I was really a strict mom. So, sometimes he would, he would correct me in front of. Galit na galit ako eh ayoko no'n na cinocorrect niya ako. Cinocross niya ako in front of my daughter And that is a big no-no for me because I wouldn't do that to him. And then, before when he was always working late, 'yan nagagalit din

ako sa kanya. But those, in as I look back 'no, sabi ko it was all also childish. Kasi ngayon, you know, as you age, hindi na kayo gano'n kadalas mag-away. Ang pinag-aawayan na lang namin lately, yung yung katulong. "Ang tagal tagal na niyan di mo pa pinapaayos 'yan." Sa bahay, mga gan'on. So trivial. But it's ano. It's I guess you learn to appreciate each other more. And willing to let go. Before, kasi you mind every little thing. Now, um, you would pause first and say, is it really worth arguing about? 'Yung gano'n. So, I said, we are still a work in progress. And me, what the Lord really changed in me and is still changing is my ability to listen. Kasi I'm a talkative person talaga eh. Di ka pa tapos, meron na akong rebuttal diyan. Ayan. So now, medyo ano tinatame na ako ni Lord in that area. I don't know if you will agree. You can find out later.

Interviewer: I mean, nagmmake sense po 'yung mga points ninyo. You would resolve these fights through what I'm getting from what you said is parang communication?

Speaker: Yes. Yeah. And you know what, [Interviewer's Name], there are times talaga na... There are occasions where it's hard to resolve things, you know? Eh sabi sa Bible, do not sleep, do not let the sun down on your anger. Sabi ko, syempre 'di ka pa resolved. You don't want to settle yet. I'm so hurt. I'm so hurt. So parang ano eh whenever I find myself to be in that situation, to hurt him back, then that means I'm not ready to resolve things yet. So ngayon, Ina-allow ko na to let the sun pass because it's better that way because I know hindi pa resolved sa akin. And I guess gano'n din sa kanya. If he's not yet ready to resolve, we won't talk yet. But no matter how difficult the situation is, our commitment to each other is until death do us part. Gano'n. I mean, this is it 'no. No backing out.

Interviewer: Speaking of, um, our lifelong commitment, [Participant's Name], how are the other ways that you maintain your relationship apart from, um, letting things cool down and communicating?

Speaker: Okay. Um, my daughter, I would say, is a big part of ano keeping us together. Yeah. Kasi ano eh [1-5] lang kami, 'diba? So we love to do things together. And as much as we are so busy, um, our weekends are really family time 'no. And talk times. Um, we don't let it pass na we don't talk. Really talk ah quality talk. Hindi talk na nasa cellphone ka ganyan, Although, sometimes, ganyan diba magkakasama pa kayo sa table, and then you have your own gadgets. We really have to make an effort to put down our gadgets and just talk. Yeah. So we have a room here. We call it the prayer room. We go there. There's no TV, nothing. Just, you know, see trees and things. It's very calming. And that's where we talk. Or even our bedroom, you know, but no TV. Yeah. So it's really, um, and if ever we are so busy, one of us would just caution each other, hey, we are, we've been so busy. Maybe we should talk. We should just have coffee or go out 'no. 'Yan, So that's how, that's what we do. I mean, practical things that we do. Even if he doesn't drink coffee, it's just me.

Interviewer: 'Di po siya nagcocooffee.

Speaker: Hindi. Na-bypass siya di na siya nagcocooffee.

Interviewer: Ah. Health reasons po.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Um, medyo slumbook question. But for you, what is love?

Speaker: For me, a love is, um, it's cliché 'no, but the, the love is the definition of love is what Christ did for you, for us when he died in our stead. I mean, that's the greatest love. And for me, loving my

husband, kahit na if I could just give about a little bit of what Christ did for him. Um, this is what I would like. I would desire to love my husband na, to love all of him, even his faults, even his ugliness or even his, um, all of him without any restrictions, without any conditions. Yeah. That would be love. And, and, and it's sacrificial because, ano eh, kahit na there's nothing at the other end, you would still choose to love. It's a decision to love. 'Yun. That to me is love.

Interviewer: Um, daily renewed commitment po siya from what I'm understanding.

Speaker: Yes. Um, kasi yung love masyadong ano eh. Um, masyado siyang nacocommercialize, you know, what, what you see on TV or in the books. But it love is experienced first by the ultimate giver of love, which is Jesus Christ. And it changes, it changes your perspective about it. All this, uh, uh, hallmark, uh, romance, uh, ano diba, picture of it. Love is painful at times because it's not reciprocated at times 'no. Kahit na Kristiyano pa 'yan 'diba. Kahit mabait pa 'yan. It may not be reciprocated, but it's just like a child. When you care for a child, it's all me. How about me? Gano'n 'diba? So, um, that love was given first by Christ because we didn't care about him. We don't know about him, but he decided that I'll die for you so that you don't have to go to hell. So for me, that is the only benchmark. Yeah. So if ever, um, it is this person that I said my vows to [26-30] years ago, I would be committed to that because that is a vow I gave to the Lord. So it would be a sin not to, not to, not to be true to God. Kahit mahirap. You don't quit. Yeah.

Interviewer: Very unconditional po.

Speaker: Yes. Although it's it's it's ano ah, it's in, it's humanly impossible on your own. Cannot. Yeah. Only by God's grace.

Interviewer: Um, how do you know that your partner loves you po? Your husband loves you?

Speaker: Well, he stuck with me. Well, ano, um, we say the word a lot. We affirm each other. And I, ano kasi ako eh maano ako eh my love language is words of affirmation and touch. Yeah. If you're familiar with the five love languages, there's service, love, ano touch. Merong ano... ano ba yung isa. But 'yon. But I tell him that. And siya ang ano niya love language is service. I, I really appreciate him because he's really a handy man. And 'yan, mag-aayos siya dito, things like that. And because he's an [occupation], um, he, he always, I know that he would buy me things that I thought I didn't know I didn't want, like this [Brand] watch. Because I don't like it. It's so sporty. It's not me. Parang ganyan. But now it's the only watch that I wear now because I created the monster because I have to close my rings every day. So parang gano'n. So parang, ah, it's ano, I know, I know he, he might not say it often, but his gesture speaks more of that he loves me. 'Yan.

Interviewer: Actions speak louder than words.

Speaker: Yes. Yes.

Interviewer: Um, how important is love po in a relationship?

Speaker: How important is what?

Interviewer: Love in a relationship.

Speaker: Oh, of course it's the foundation 'no. Christ is love, right? God is love and it's your foundation. Kasi, um, I've heard of old people they're saying even my parents 'no, they're saying ah we're just saying

kasi tradition eh. We're not supposed to separate 'no but there's really no love there and it's so as a child witnessing that with my parents that they're just there because it's tradition it's um it brings out insecurity in a in a child. So for me, yes by all means love is should be present yeah because if you don't love the person how could you stick with him. How could you be committed. How could you do lengths and um be willing to be hurt several times 'no. 'Yun kasi it can hurt I said. Love can hurt.

Interviewer: Um would you say that the relationship is good for you po? 'Cause you mentioned [Participant's Name] din na that [Partner's Name]'s love language is acts of service and um he helped you with your career in banking so I just I'm curious to know.

Speaker: If this relationship is...

Interviewer: Good for you.

Speaker: Oh yes. it does. it's it is. [redacted]

Interviewer: Grabe po. That's a very existential insight and. But um would you say that uh you feel supported po in the relationship for example...

Speaker: Very much so. Yes very much. Um, as I've said he is my best friend in whatever uh struggles that I have he knows. He's my prayer partner. He prays about he prays for me and I know that. Ano um I would say um that's why in marriage bago pa lang kami kinasal, pinagpray na eh. I knew I knew he was he is God's best for me because ano it it works it really works yeah. And I I wouldn't I I also prayed that we would be able to minister to other couples and and God granted that. I'm not saying that we already are experts no we're not we're far from it but it's nice to grow with other couples and learn from each other. Kasi we don't stop from learning, 'diba? Don't stop um learning new things and adjusting to new things 'no. Ngayon puro ang iniisip na lang namin eh, "pagod na tayo dito na lang tayo sa bahay." Kaya team bahay kami ngayon. Tinatamad na lumabas.

Interviewer: At ang init-init din po ano?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Um, do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker: Oh very much. Very.

Interviewer: Uh why would you say so I guess?

Speaker: Well number one um I know there's no third party. I know there's uh I know my husband is faithful and he's been very faithful to me and he knows too that I am faithful to him. So um based ano yan eh solid foundation of safe. I know that uh even if we're not together 24/7 I know that um because he loves the Lord and because we are accountable to God first 'yon. The safe this uh safety is not derived from the person giving it but it's foremost coming from God who is able to mold that person to be the kind the godly person that he is supposed to be so that for him and and and also for me. Um I said that because in my my former relationship, 'yun 'yung lagi kong ano, trauma I guess because my former my only my [1st-5th] boyfriend he was not a faithful guy. Yeah so, 'yun, and for me that was that was devastating for me because I'm a loyal person.

Interviewer: Speaking of uh growing and changing po uh throughout uh different relationships, did your relationship with your husband change you?

Speaker: Um change for the better I hope? I think. Um but it was not because of him. I always say this I only count it only because of the Lord in the same manner that I guess he was changed. Kasi syempre as you you're still two different individuals eh, and as you uh diba, the two will become one flesh the two will become one then you change each other somehow to be able to coexist, 'no. And that's why before, I would say if I'm selfish I'm less selfish now. If before I am so trivial now I can be less trivial. 'Yun. Things like that. And so yeah, God allowed it to... God allowed this marriage to work uh by His grace so that we can be better persons and I guess that's the design of marriage eh. Na you compliment each other and you become a better version of yourself.

Interviewer: Ang ganda po ng insight in complimenting each other, growing with each other. Speaking of um, what about your husband? Did he change during the relationship as well?

Speaker: Yes. Before, ano yan eh, baduy. Just kidding aside. Uh, dati ano siya, uh, well uh I would say he talks less before. He is a very private, kaya nga sabi ko suplado because he's a man of few words. Um and and in our early on in our marriage, it was a struggle for him for me to draw him out kasi he doesn't speak much 'no, tapos madaldal pa ako so nasasapawan ko siya. But now, mas madaldal pa siya sa'kin. Parang, I have to shut up when he talks, especially in heated argument. So, I would say 'yun, nag-change siya doon. And, um before um, he is not as demonstrative perhaps in terms of uh showing his feelings to me. Hindi siya ma-akap. Hindi siya ma ma-kiss. Alam mo 'yun? Um and I would tell him sometimes to, you know um, you know I tend to compare him before and that was a no-no. I learned that I'm not supposed to do that. Um I also saw from my dad that he was he is very, you know, he was very endearing to my mom, ganyan. Sabi ko, why don't you do the same to me, parang gano'n. But now, I I would say he he tries, he tries, but uh, it's always a two-pronged process eh, [Interviewer's Name]. It's not just one person. It's always it's always the two of you together being changed. Yeah, iron sharpens iron, so it's not just one iron that gets sharpened it's both, 'diba? Yeah and the friction sharpens your both.

Interviewer: It was going through it together po 'no and complementing each other.

Speaker: Yeah, so it can work both ways, right? Can compliment and when you are against each other it the friction causes you to be a better person 'no, because you had that you had that conscious thought, "hey hey we have to reconcile," "hey we have to you know and how do we reconcile?" Somebody somebody has to give something like that. But it's a hard lesson to learn, takes years and prayer.

Interviewer: Years. Thank you. Decades po 'no?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: And prayers. Um now for the next set of questions po, um I'll be sharing my screen and I'll be asking from not at all true to completely true if I were to ask, "my partner usually really listens to me." What would be your answer po?

Speaker: Oh very true. Pero 'pag inaantok, "hey did you understand what I said?" Oo, minsan kasi alam mo, ano eh you have to really call isa pa, lalo na 'pag may [Show Name], hay nako. Hindi niya ako naririnig. Gano'n din naman ako sa kanya when I'm so in the zone as my work. Sometimes, he has to

repeat it. Yeah. But it's most of the time naman very true. He listens to me when we have our talk and he listens.

Interviewer: What about, um, "my partner usually is responsive to my needs?"

Speaker: I would say okay uh responsive doon sa mga yeah needs. When you say needs it's something that you cannot live without, right? I would say completely true. Pero yung need needs kunyari like, 'pag, "you don't hug me." 'Yun naman pwede namang ano 'yun eh, kaartehan ko lang 'yan. So 'yun moderately true. Kasi may side siya na ano, eh gusto ko na lagi akong cinucuddle ganyan. Pero little needs 'yun. I have to qualify it's really the needs you know for your, for your existence, you know, something that cannot live without. Yes, completely true.

Interviewer: Um just to clarify po. You gave concrete answers naman po sa previous, this one the responsiveness like you mentioned, uh, basic necessities and kind of had quote unquote or different needs. Um would you have a concrete example for why you answered very true to my partner usually really listens to me?

Speaker: Because ano eh um um, he doesn't have to ask me. He knows already like this [Brand Name] watch he knows it. Um and then when he tries to buys, whenever let's say um, let's say there was a time that we didn't we didn't have a helper and I was really exasperated from where I had to work, I had to cook. He would and I told him I was really frustrated and I told him you know it would it would help if you, um, initiated to help in the kitchen 'yun. And he did and I appreciated him for that. Ngayon, marunong nang mag-fried rice. Ngayon, 'diba? Siya 'pag steak, siya nagluluto. Mga ganyan. So, it didn't it didn't require me to throw a tantrum, 'diba? But I just told it to him and and uh and he listened he he was sensitive. I guess it's not just listening, it's being sensitive to my needs, 'yun. Well, of course you listen yeah pero you listen 'yung 'yung act of service niya was really more, because he really saw the need. He really saw that I was hurting yeah, and and uh he saw to it that I that that need that I I needed. I was parang ano eh I was really I was I was hurt because I was tired ganyan, and he he was very responsive to me, gano'n. Tapos uh kay [Name], my daughter, um, he took on teaching my daughter when she was in high school. I used to [occupation] kasi 'yun dati 'yan before ang aking job, but because he saw me to be ano with a tight, ano na, nag I I;m throwing a fit na kasi, ano na eh, nagshort fuse na ako eh. He took on the the role of teaching my daughter. 'Yun.

Interviewer: I see.

Speaker: So he can read me.

Interviewer: Why not um why seven instead of six or eight po?

Speaker: Because there's still some things I guess like uh that I still have to um tell him. Maybe um it's it's uh something that has to be like like may mga frustrations pa rin ako sa kanya na... I always tell him na, um, I want I want to be desired. Parang ganyan. Sabi ko sa kanya parang, tanda-tanda na natin. Thinking out loud. I kind of feel that so. But as I've said, I have to learn to love him for for how God designed him. To love him for who he is, not because he failed in this angle or he won't he came short. I've learned to appreciate and love him for that yeah. Ang hirap naman ng perpekto 'no. Wala ng spice. 'Diba?

Interviewer: Boring po siguro ng buhay ng perfect.

Interviewer: Um just to clarify as well uh, you have two answers po. Why... would you rather stick to the nine na parang needs or the five na parang um mga lambingan po?

Speaker: Oh sige na nga, very true na nga para in between kasi, kasi alam mo, [Interviewer's Name] and 'yan eh, depende siguro sa mood ko 'no. If I'm selfish, if I'm being um if I'm so committed to my own hurts, I would probably rate him a four or even a three. But I've as I've said, it's not about me in a relationship it's about the two of you because if I'm saying that uh, let's say I rate him a three and that means uh there's that other end of the rope na siya, how he sees me naman 'diba. So, um it's that act of giving again eh. Would I'd rather be um serving myself because I my needs are not met or maybe there's a reason for him not being able to meet that? But for me my resolve is, even if he doesn't meet it, I'm willing to be thankful and to be happy for what he can give at that moment. Kasi hindi naman parati eh na gano'n. 'Diba? You get what I mean? It's not always like that. I mean if you have you know marriage or early relationship it's not about taking tabs. It's not about it, 'diba? It's the totality of it all eh 'no. And if you love a person, even if you don't really make scores, 'diba? There's no scores. There's no range.

Interviewer: Yes po. Ang hirap po if you keep score of everything.

Speaker: Yes, because if you if you begin to keep scores, you're trying to ano, you're trying to compete with each other or you know set a bar. I mean we always miss the bar eh, 'diba?

Interviewer: Oh I assure you that this is for research purposes only.

Speaker: It's good to take a look at things, diba? Kasi as I've said, depende sa ano yan, sa mood mo, right?

Interviewer: And um [Participant's Name], uh you mentioned din po wanting to be desired is something important to you. I hope it's not uh uncomfy that I ask and feel free to say if this is too sensitive for you to share, but I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple po.

Speaker: Okay. Oh yeah. You know ano eh, um when I was younger talagang ano I'm really the kinky one and I would really pull around him. For me kasi it's um sex is something to be enjoyed in the bounce of marriage and I was complaining a lot before, but again it's really a design that is um preview only to the two of you, 'diba? So um and and and sex is not just the act itself, it's everything the love language the, sometimes just words you know um, or looking at each other 'yun, or when even preparing an intimate date, or whatever, or in bed just cuddling. That um the ideals now are being taken out you know. Kasi syempre, when you enter into a marriage, there's this ideal and and and what your exposure is somehow paints that picture, but when you're into the marriage, you make it your own. So um and this has largely to do with how the Lord is is um because He's always involved eh in our relationship, right? No matter what we do, especially in the marriage here um, of course there are ideals, there are hopes that I want, right? But again, I always go back to um loving this person as God created him you know. Should be more important than this ideal that I have in mind. Kasi flawed din 'yun, 'diba? Everything that you you read in the books or watch in the movies, they're flawed, 'diba? So why make that as a model, 'diba? It's something personal, you're right. It's something that you create together. 'Yun. So um, we are we are you know we are ano, if you're asking if we're still doing it, yes we do, but maybe not as intense as before kasi matanda na. Inantok na. But the romance is still there. It doesn't have to be physical you know yeah.

Interviewer: You mentioned po the love languages, the words, the cuddling, the romance po 'no. How satisfied are you po with your sex life?

Speaker: Me? Um, I would say, I would say um, I'm pretty satisfied. Well I wasn't as satisfied before when I was younger, but now I guess I changed 'no. Um, kasi nga tinatamad na siguro kasi menopause na ako, 'diba? You're not as your libido has gone down, so for me, I prefer na lang na just sleeping with each other, ganyan lang, ng cuddling, ganyan lang, or a little bit of kissing. 'Yun. But for me, ano eh, 'yung minamasahe niya ako, gustong-gusto ko 'yun, 'yan. Different, different ano na, strokes.

Interviewer: Um, last question po on that note. How often do you become intimate with your husband po these days?

Speaker: These days? Oh um I would say intimacy again it's not just the the intercourse, intimate is yung talk times namin. I would say we're still very much frequent, especially now that we bring my daughter to school every [Day], and it's very early. So after that, we have we have no intimate talks together, 'yun in the morning. 'Diba matanda na talaga eh. As in [Time].

Interviewer: Aga po.

Speaker: 'Diba? But 'yun, it's intimate, and then ano um yeah just by being together, just holding hands, and doing quiet time together, reading the bible together, talk about things, 'yun. To me, that's being intimate. Hindi lang yung intimate about physical, no.

Interviewer: Um, on that note po, uh in general, how satisfied would you say you are with your relationship?

Speaker: Oh, completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Okay. Completely satisfied po. I just need to check. We're almost done actually. I just have to check the right scale.

Interviewer: I think it should be um...

Speaker: Meron bang not at all discompletely, not all satisfied? Kawawa naman.

Interviewer: Ang dami pong double negatives.

Interviewer: So, if zero is not at all satisfied and ten is completely satisfied, how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship?

Speaker: Um, how would I rate my satisfaction with our with my relationship with my husband? I'm completely satisfied. As I've said, um I would have I would have not imagined myself to be with another guy, and I until now, I I'm still in love with him, and until now, I he's still the person, he's still my my most favorite person yeah. Yes and siya yung gustong-gusto ko kasama, 'yan. Kasi matiyaga din siya eh. I mean, wala 'diba there's that person that you'd like to be with, kahit na with my siblings whom I'm close to. [reda

Interviewer: Bawal po. Relation ay ethics po.

Interviewer: [26-30] years na po kayo. But um, ayun po. We are very close to wrapping up, and I just like to summarize what I learned about you in the past hour. [Portion Redacted] And um was that right? Is there anything that you'd like to add?

Speaker: Yes. Uh and yeah we're still a work in progress and uh, siguro kung hindi ka na work in progress, patay ka na 'no. So yes, we're still excited on how the Lord will reveal Himself to us in our marriage and to each other. And hopefully this interview would somehow uh help you you know that um yeah the the marriage could that can be successful if Christ is in it.

Interviewer: Before we end, uh and thank you so much again [Participant's Name] for your time. I just also want to be transparent uh about how we'll handle your data um. I can stop sharing that. But uh ayun po, as a research project, we want to be as ethical as possible, and we want to do as little harm as possible. So um I want to know which data sharing option you're most comfy with. Option one po is transcript portions can be shared, none of which will be identified to you, so the the identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. But um option two is that the whole transcript will be shared but of course, we will remove sensitive and identifying details, so completely de-identified, completely anonymized po. Um would you be more comfy po with option one or option two?

Speaker: Option one is the transcript. First of all because it's not it doesn't point to us because of course we value our privacy, but basically what I've shared is is really what we want to share to the people 'no yeah.

Interviewer: So um option one is what you're leaning more towards po?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Sigé po. Thank you so much again [Participant's Name] for participating initially. Um last the last po talaga. One last thing lang po that I'll ask um, can you recommend to close people in your life that we could possibly also interview about this topic?

Speaker: Um, we have friends like uh I don't know if [Name] has mentioned about [Name] and [Name]. They they are they've been married for [20-25] about the same as us, I think [26-30] years and then there are a couple missionaries that are our friends good friends yeah yeah. I can ask them they want to be interviewed yeah sure.

Interviewer: I think I've also contacted [Name] from [Name].

Speaker: Ayun 'yun. Si [Name] and [Name]. It has to be [20-25] years 'no? It has to be [20-25] years. Let me check with our life group kasi yeah I think mga bata pa kasi minimisteran namin eh. Um we'll check and then I'll let you know, anyway I still have your number. How many ba? How many subjects do you need?

Interviewer: Uh we need nine couples.

Speaker: Ah nine couples.

Interviewer: Very specific po yung um demographic.

Speaker: Okay but at least [20-25] years nang married.

Interviewer: But you're amenable to be contacted po by our research team for this purpose.

Speaker: For yeah. Wag lang pag ano ha, training hours kasi 'pag nagttrain ako talagang hindi mo ako makakausap eh.

Interviewer: Of course po. So um thank you again for your openness Ms. [Participant's Name] I will let you go for real po, and um I guess I'll just ask when [Partner's Name] is coming.

Speaker: Oh yeah, he's coming. He's coming. I'll call him.

Interviewer: Sige po.

Speaker: Okay. Thank you again.

Interviewer: Have a good evening.

Speaker: Kumain ka na ba?

Interviewer: Yes po.

Speaker: Okay. Just a moment.

Interviewer: Rest up now.

Speaker: Okay thank you. Dad, you're next. Make sure that that you answer nicely okay.